



PARTNER GUIDE

Partnership with IMWIRSA

A practical guide for seafarers' centres, missions and welfare organisations considering cooperation with IMWIRSA as part of the international partner network.

WHO WE ARE

About IMWIRSA

IMWIRSA — the International Maritime Welfare Innovation Research and Support Association — is an independent international initiative in seafarer welfare, bringing together research, practical experience and modern digital solutions.

Our task is to help develop accessible, up-to-date welfare infrastructure in ports, grounded in seafarers' real needs, verifiable data, and cooperation with organisations that already work with seafarers.

IMWIRSA does not replace seafarers' centres, missions, unions or other welfare organisations. Every partner keeps its name, governance, traditions and independence. Our role is to build tools, research and practical models that help the existing system work more effectively, and make the support available to a seafarer in port easier to find and understand.

Evidence-based	Partnership-based	Technology-enabled
Research, seafarer surveys and independent industry data help identify real needs.	We work with existing welfare organisations, without replacing them or interfering in their governance.	MWApp connects verified local information and existing welfare services with the seafarer in port.

THE PRACTICAL MODEL

Four Elements of the Practical Model

- 1 Port Card** — Verified information about a specific port and terminal: getting to and from the ship, transport, seafarers' centres, essential services, shops, City Life, Spiritual Care and Union Help.
- 2 MWApp Port Coordinator** — Checks local data for their port and passes on changes through the IMWIRSA MWApp Bot. Information is verified by IMWIRSA Central Office before it goes live.
- 3 MWApp** — A practical digital assistant for the seafarer in port. It provides verified local information; the AI Assistant helps find what's needed, and Human Support IMWIRSA is available when required.
- 4 Wellness** — A chance for short rest and recovery during long sea contracts and limited time ashore. MWApp shows partner options and puts seafarers in touch with the Wellness Host.

WHAT CHANGES FOR YOUR ORGANISATION

What You Keep — What You Gain

Partnership with IMWIRSA adds to your organisation's work rather than replacing it. Your centre or mission keeps its own identity, governance, funding, and the right to decide its own direction.

YOU KEEP	YOU GAIN
✓ Full organisational independence ✓ Your name, history, traditions and identity ✓ Your own governance and funding ✓ Freedom to work with other networks and organisations ✓ The right to end the partnership at any time	✓ A presence in IMWIRSA's international partner network ✓ Greater visibility for your centre and its services to seafarers through MWApp ✓ Exchange of practical experience with other welfare organisations ✓ Access to IMWIRSA's methodology and digital tools ✓ The opportunity to take part in developing the Wellness track and other joint initiatives

The Role of the MWApp Port Coordinator

To keep the port card current, a partner organisation may appoint an MWApp Port Coordinator — a staff member, volunteer, or another person with a good understanding of local conditions.

The coordinator checks local information and passes on changes through the IMWIRSA MWApp Bot. Before publication or an update, the data is verified by IMWIRSA Central Office.

The format of involvement stays flexible. In certain cases, where IMWIRSA's budget and the scope of local work allow, a coordinator may be engaged on a paid basis; this is not an automatic condition of partnership.

NO HIDDEN CONDITIONS

How Partnership Begins

Partnership begins with a short introduction and agreeing on your organisation's practical role. IMWIRSA does not require changes to your centre's structure, mandatory contributions, or exclusivity.

NOT REQUIRED	WHAT'S NEEDED
✗ Mandatory financial contributions ✗ Restructuring your organisation ✗ Changes to your charter or governance ✗ Exclusivity — you can keep working with other networks ✗ Buying new software or equipment	✓ One interested contact person from your organisation ✓ An MWApp Port Coordinator to check local port information ✓ Completing the initial port questionnaire, with updates as things change ✓ Telegram on the coordinator's phone to use the IMWIRSA MWApp Bot ✓ A short introductory call online, and a readiness for practical cooperation

Four Steps

- 1 Get in touch with IMWIRSA** — Tell us briefly about your organisation and your port.
- 2 Introductory call** — We discuss the format of cooperation, the tasks involved, and the role of the MWApp Port Coordinator.
- 3 Organisation profile and port questionnaire** — We put together a profile of your centre or mission and gather local data for the port card.
- 4 Verification and go-live** — IMWIRSA Central Office verifies the data; once verified, the information is published or updated in MWApp.

Ready to discuss partnership?

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